

SE TAYLOR

Geopolitical Researcher

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PROFILE

Geopolitical researcher with a background in International Relations and experience conducting independent investigative research into government transparency, international diplomacy, and conflict dynamics. Skilled at reconstructing complex event sequences from fragmented and multilingual sources, applying open-source intelligence methods, and producing evidence-based analysis. Particular focus on Africa-China relations, governance and accountability, and the strategic dynamics shaping the Global South.

EXPERIENCE

Independent Investigative Research Project | UK Cabinet Office — Freedom of Information Tribunal matter | *2023 – present*

- Conducted a three-year and ongoing Freedom of Information (FOI) investigation involving the UK Cabinet Office, seeking disclosure of government records relating to a high-level diplomatic engagement during an ongoing armed conflict.
- Independently navigated all three stages of the statutory process — Internal Review, the Information Commissioner's Office, and the First-Tier Tribunal, drafting all legal submissions, procedural correspondence, and grounds of appeal submitted to two public institutions without legal representation.
- Evaluated legal and procedural questions relating to government transparency, statutory disclosure obligations, and exemptions under the UK Freedom of Information Act 2000.

Geopolitics Research Assistant | *Listening to the Other Side* | *2023 – 2025*

- Reconstructed detailed diplomatic timelines by identifying, verifying, and synthesising fragmented information from multilingual media, official statements, open-source intelligence, and government publications.
- Conducted over two years of geopolitical research supporting investigative work and ten editorial projects on international diplomacy, armed conflict, and under-reported political developments spanning several decades.

- Tracked bilateral and multilateral diplomatic developments, identifying geopolitical, security, and foreign policy trends affecting international relations.
- Produced and narrated analytical briefings interpreting the public statements of world leaders, including President Vladimir Putin, for research and public understanding.

EDUCATION

BA International Relations | Stellenbosch University | 2019 – 2022

Focus: International security, conflict analysis, governance, and Africa-China relations.

SKILLS

Research & Intelligence: Open-source intelligence (OSINT); source verification; chronology reconstruction and conflict tracking; multilingual research synthesis; comparative analysis.

Documents & Disclosure: Government document analysis; Freedom of Information requests, appeals, and tribunal submissions; procedural correspondence with public bodies.

Languages: English (native), isiZulu (native), Mandarin (study in progress).

AREAS OF FOCUS

Africa–China relations · Geopolitical analysis · International security and conflict analysis · Open-source intelligence (OSINT) · Government transparency and access to information · Policy analysis · Governance in the Global South